

RILEY K. KENDALL

Doctoral Candidate, Behavioral Neuroscience | Part-Time Lecturer, Psychology and Physical Therapy
Santa Monica, CA 90404 | 425.417.8898 | rileykendall@comcast.net

EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles <i>Ph.D., Behavioral Neuroscience (Psychology); GPA: 4.0</i> • Doctoral candidate; advanced to candidacy Spring 2025. • M.A., Psychology, 2022.	Expected 2027
Chapman University <i>M.S., Computational and Data Sciences; GPA: 3.98</i>	2021
Chapman University <i>B.S., Biochemistry and Molecular Biology, magna cum laude; Minor: Computational Neuroscience; GPA: 3.82</i>	2020

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Part-Time Lecturer <i>Chapman University, Departments of Psychology and Physical Therapy</i> • Instructor of record for upper-division undergraduate Physiological Psychology. • Co-instructor for graduate-Physical Therapy Neuroscience II with primary responsibility for developing and teaching half of the course curriculum and assessments. • Design and deliver lectures, apply learning activities and assessments across undergraduate and doctoral-professional programs. • Supervise and mentor undergraduate teaching assistants in course facilitation, student support, and pedagogical development; three TAs have developed teaching-related posters for Chapman's TA Poster Fair, including one presented in Spring 2026 and two forthcoming in Fall 2026.	2024-Present
Graduate Student Researcher <i>University of California, Los Angeles, Behavioral Neuroscience</i>	2021-Present
Teaching Assistant <i>University of California, Los Angeles, Department of Psychology</i> • Taught weekly sections in Pavlovian and instrumental learning, neuroanatomy, and introductory psychology; led reviews and assessed student work.	2022-2023

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Behavioral Neuroscience Researcher <i>University of California, Los Angeles</i> • Investigate neural and behavioral mechanisms of decision-making, motivation, learning, and memory in rat foraging tasks. • Use electrophysiological recordings targeting the hippocampal region, computational modeling, and quantitative analysis.	2021-Present
Bioinformatics Researcher <i>Chapman University</i> • Studied SARS-CoV-2 Mpro and the potential role of natural products in preventing infection using BIOVIA and PyMOL.	2021
Computational Neuroscience Research Intern <i>Allen Institute for Brain Science</i> • Compared gene expression in the M1 region across species using computational analysis in R.	2020
Biochemistry Researcher, Catalyst Research Lab <i>Chapman University</i> • Studied interactions between calmodulin and the MA matrix protein of HIV-1 Gag using fluorescence spectroscopy and anisotropy.	2017-2020
Biomedical Sciences Research Intern <i>Augusta University</i> • Researched signaling pathways in osteoblast cells from mice in controlled, in-vitro conditions, specifically investigating how osteoblasts respond to certain challenges and stresses and the role of bone marrow fat in age-related bone loss.	2019

TEACHING INNOVATION AND SCHOLARSHIP

Immersive Physiological Psychology Case Studies

2026-Present

Chapman University

- Designed and implemented two collaborative case-study activities that ask students to integrate physiological psychology concepts with clinical and contextual evidence.

PUBLICATIONS AND MANUSCRIPTS

Peer-Reviewed

Logue, R. S., Garcia, A. K., Bejarano, B. A., Fujioka, T., Duke, M., **Kendall, R. K.**, & Wikenheiser, A. M. (2025). Rats pursue food and leisure following the same rational principles. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America*, 122(44), e2520884122. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2520884122>

Ang, D., **Kendall, R.**, & Atamian, H. S. (2023). Virtual and In Vitro Screening of Natural Products Identifies Indole and Benzene Derivatives as Inhibitors of SARS-CoV-2 Main Protease (M^{pro}). *Biology*, 12(4), 519. <https://doi.org/10.3390/biology12040519>

Kendall, R. K., & Wikenheiser, A. M. (2022). Quitting while you're ahead: Patch foraging and temporal cognition. *Behavioral neuroscience*, 136(5), 467–478. <https://doi.org/10.1037/bne0000526>

Pierce, J. L., Roberts, R. L., Yu, K., **Kendall, R. K.**, Kaiser, H., Davis, C., Johnson, M. H., Hill, W. D., Isales, C. M., Bollag, W. B., Hamrick, M. W., & McGee-Lawrence, M. E. (2020). Kynurenine suppresses osteoblastic cell energetics in vitro and osteoblast numbers in vivo. *Experimental Gerontology*, 130, 110818. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.exger.2019.110818>

Manuscripts in Preparation

Kendall, R. K., Garcia, A. K., Bejarano, B. A., Alkire, A., Nguyen, J., Rafifar, R., Logue, R. S., Fujioka, T., & Wikenheiser, A. M. (in prep). *Adaptive patch-leaving but paradoxical patch-choice decisions in rats performing a spatial foraging task*.

Kendall, R. K. (in prep). *Designing immersive mystery case studies to promote applied learning*. Intended for submission to the FUN workshop issue of the Journal of Undergraduate Neuroscience Education (JUNE).

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Kendall, R. K. *Designing immersive case studies to promote applied learning*. Oral presentation at the Faculty for Undergraduate Neuroscience (FUN) Summer Workshop, 2026.

Kendall, R. K., et al. *Comparing time and effort costs in a free-choice foraging task for rats*. Poster presented at the Society for Neuroscience Annual Meeting and the Decision-Making Affinity Group Symposium, 2024.

Kendall, R. K., et al. *Evaluating the effects of temporal and effort costs in foraging task decisions*. Poster presented at the UCLA Brain Research Institute Neuroscience Retreat, 2024.

Kendall, R. K., et al. *Evaluating the effects of temporal and effort costs in foraging task decisions*. Poster presented at the International Behavioral Neuroscience Society Annual Meeting, 2023.

AWARDS AND HONORS

National Science Foundation (NSF) Conference Travel Award 2026

Student Mentored Research Fellowship (SMRF) 2023

University of California, Los Angeles

Graduate Student Research Mentorship (GSRM) Award 2022

University of California, Los Angeles

Biochemistry and Molecular Biology Honors Program 2020

Chapman University

Cheverton Award Finalist, Outstanding Undergraduate 2020

Chapman University

Outstanding Leadership Award 2020

Schmid College of Science and Technology, Chapman University

Eldridge Award for Outstanding STAR Intern 2019

Augusta University

Presidential Scholarship 2016-2020

Chapman University

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND TRAINING

Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching and Learning (CIRTL) Associate Certification	2026
CIRTL Teaching and Learning Workshops	2026
Faculty for Undergraduate Neuroscience (FUN) Summer Workshop	2026
ERG 130: Cognitive Human Factors and Ergonomics	2026
ERG 110: Evidence-Based Human Factors and Ergonomics	2025
Neurological Preceptorship, Valley Health Winchester Medical Center	2018
<i>CIRTL workshops: Rethinking Assessment Design in the Age of AI: A Practical Framework; Real-World and Hands-On Learning: Learning-Centered Teaching Strategies for Student Success; Research as a High-Impact Practice in STEM Education; Teaching Transferable Skills and Work-Integrated Learning in the College Classroom.</i>	
<i>ERG courses: 8-week accelerated online courses in human factors and ergonomics offered through UC Berkeley's Center for Occupational and Environmental Health (COEH)</i>	

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Faculty for Undergraduate Neuroscience (FUN)	2026-Present
Society for Neuroscience (SfN)	2023-2025
International Behavioral Neuroscience Society (IBNS)	2023

TECHNICAL AND RESEARCH SKILLS

Programming and analysis: Python, R, MATLAB; mathematical modeling; mixed-effects models; machine learning; neural decoding; biostatistics; data visualization.

Neuroscience and laboratory methods: Electrophysiology; Neuropixels; SpikeGadgets; spike sorting and curation (Kilosort, Phy); Bonsai visual tracking; animal behavioral testing; stereotaxic surgery (neural implants, viral injections); histology; fluorescence microscopy; fluorescence spectroscopy.

Teaching and leadership: Curriculum and course development; evidence-based teaching; active learning; assessment design; lecturing; undergraduate mentorship; scientific communication; leadership; adaptability

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

Undergraduate Research Mentor	2023-Present
<i>University of California, Los Angeles</i>	
• Mentored nine undergraduate researchers in experimental design, research methodology, data collection, analysis, and scientific communication. • Trained students in wet-lab research techniques (7 students) and computational methods (3 students). • Guided students in scientific communication and poster development; (5 students presented research at scientific conferences)	
Volunteer	
<i>Brain Awareness Week, UCLA BRI</i>	2024-2026
<i>The Compton Initiative, Compton</i>	2024-2026
<i>Habitat for Humanity, East Los Angeles</i>	2024-2025
<i>The Salvation Army, Santa Monica</i>	2022-2024
<i>Schmid Student Leadership Council Member</i>	2018-2020